

Business challenge: Details in the data

In this activity, you apply what you've learned about Google Sheets to help Sherrie West and the team at On the Rise Bakery solve a business challenge.



Task 1

Sherrie informs you that she has recently collected numbers from On the Rise stores across the globe and added them to a spreadsheet.

Sherrie asks for your help. She wants to analyze the data to better understand the current and future employment situation at On the Rise. She also hopes to share her findings and collaborate with the On the Rise leadership team. To achieve these goals, Sherrie needs your help to leverage the power of Google Sheets.

Complete the following steps:

1. Open the spreadsheet [On the Rise employee openings – North America – East region](#). Make a copy to My Drive when prompted.
2. Rename your copy with your first and last name to read: "On the Rise employee openings_YOURNAME."
3. Star the Google Sheet.

Task 2

You inform Sherrie that you've renamed and starred the spreadsheet to make it easy to locate in Google Drive.

Sherrie thanks and tells you she recently received an update from On the Rise Fort Lauderdale store owner Yousef Amadi. Yousef just uploaded a new Google Sheet with employment data from his location. He has named the Sheet "On the Rise employee openings – Ft. Lauderdale."

Sherrie requests that you add Yousef's data to her main spreadsheet.

Later, Sherrie informs you that unfortunately On the Rise store Charleston has closed permanently. She asks you to remove that store's data from the spreadsheet.

Complete the following steps:

1. Open your Google Sheet "On the Rise employee openings_YOURNAME."
2. Then, open [On the Rise employee openings - Ft Lauderdale](#) and copy the values found in **Row 4**.
3. Paste the data from **Row 4** in the Ft Lauderdale Sheet into a new row, **Row 21** in "On the Rise employment openings_YOURNAME." Select **Paste special** and choose **Values only** to paste only the numeric values and none of the formatting from the spreadsheet of Yousef.
4. Select the row containing the Charleston data and delete it.
5. Close the "On the Rise employee openings - Ft Lauderdale" tab.

Task 3

In order to help Sherrie make "On the Rise employee openings_YOURNAME" easier to navigate, you offer to make some formatting changes. You freeze the header, merge ranges to eliminate duplication. You also wrap text, align data, add colors to differentiate each quarter, and color the borders.

Complete the following steps:

1. Freeze the header of the spreadsheet.
 - a. Select **Row 3**.
 - b. From the **View** menu, select **Freeze** and choose **Up to current row**.
2. Merge the ranges that follow. Select the cells and from the **Format** menu select **Merge cells** and choose **Merge all**.
 - a. Employee Openings C1:N1
 - b. Actual C2:H2
 - c. Forecast I2:N2
3. Select **Column A**. From the **Format** menu, select **Text wrapping**, and choose **Wrap**.
4. Resize columns **K**, **M**, and **N**. Select the column, right-click, select **Resize column**, and choose **Fit to data**.
5. Select **B1:N20**. From the **Format** menu, select **Align**, and choose **Center** and **Middle**.
6. Make each quarter a different color. Select the range, Fill color, and choose the following colors:
 - a. Q1 (**C4:E20**) choose **light yellow 3**.

- b. Q2 (**F4:H20**) choose **light yellow 2**.
 - c. Q3 (**I4:K20**) choose **light blue 3**.
 - d. Q4 (**L4:N20**) choose **light blue 2**.
7. Make the cell borders dark gray.
- a. Select cells **A1:N20**.
 - b. Select **Borders**.
 - c. Choose **All borders**.
 - d. Choose **Dark gray 3**.

Task 4

Sherrie is still having a difficult time with the data, so you offer to make some more updates to make the Sheet easier to navigate.

Start by sorting data by city A > Z. Next, filter the entries by state. Then, name each range after the corresponding month.

Complete the following steps:

1. Sort the data by city.
 - a. Select **Column A**.
 - b. Select the **down arrow** and choose **Sort sheet A → Z**.
2. Set up a filter by state.
 - a. Select **Column B**.
 - b. From the top menu, select **Create a filter**.
 - c. Try filtering by state. How many stores are in New York? Pennsylvania?
 - d. Reset the filter to show all states.
3. Name a range for each month. Select the range, right-click, and select **Define the named range**.
 - a. C4:C20 "Jan"
 - b. D4:D20 "Feb"
 - c. E4:E20 "Mar"
 - d. F4:F20 "Apr"
 - e. G4:G20 "May"
 - f. H4:H20 "Jun"
 - g. I4:I20 "Jul"
 - h. J4:J20 "Aug"
 - i. K4:K20 "Sep"
 - j. L4:L20 "Oct"
 - k. M4:M20 "Nov"

I. N4:N20 "Dec"

Task 5

Next, to help Sherrie better understand what is happening each month and over the year as a whole, you apply two formulas: SUM and AVERAGE. You tell Sherrie that naming the ranges helps simplify the formulas.

You use a SUM formula to calculate the total job openings for each month. You then combine all the monthly totals to calculate the total job vacancies for the year.

To determine which stores are experiencing the most turnover, you calculate the yearly average of job openings per store. You apply the AVERAGE formula to each On the Rise location.

Complete the following steps:

1. In cell A21, enter "Total."
2. Calculate the total job openings per month using a SUM formula and your named ranges.
 - a. For January, apply the formula **C21=SUM(Jan)**
 - b. For February, apply the formula **D21=SUM(Feb)**
 - c. For March, apply the formula **E21=SUM(Mar)**
 - d. Complete similarly for the remaining months.
3. In cell O3, enter "Average."
4. Calculate the yearly average of job openings per store by applying the AVERAGE formula to column O.
 - a. For Albany, apply the formula **O4 =average(C4:N4)**
 - b. Double-click the bottom right corner of cell O4 or drag the bottom-right corner of cell O4 to O20 to reveal averages for all cities.
 - c. Select column O, and from the toolbar, choose **Decrease decimal places** to round values in this column to one decimal place.
5. Bold **Row 21**, and **Column O**.
6. Select **C21:O21**. From the **Format** menu, select **Align**, and choose **Center** and **Middle**.
7. Repeat step 6 for **Column O**.

Task 6

Sherrie tells you she shares the spreadsheet with the On the Rise leadership team soon. She is concerned about accidental data changes and wants to make sure current store data is

protected. She'd like Thomas to be able to make updates if necessary, so you assign him as an editor for the protected range.

Complete the following steps:

1. From the **Data** menu, choose **Protect sheets and ranges**.
2. Enter a description, and select **Range** and choose **C4:N20**.
3. Select **Set permissions**. Choose **Restrict who can edit this range** and **Custom**.
4. Add Thomas Omar as an editor. In this case though, use an alternative email address that you have access to, or ask a colleague or friend if you can share the file with them as part of a training exercise.
5. Click **Done**.
6. Click **Share** to grant editor access to the spreadsheet.

Task 7

1. Share the spreadsheet with the leadership team (ask another colleague or friend) as a Commenter. To share silently, you can uncheck the **Notify people** box when sharing.

Next, you will play the part of someone on the leadership team.

2. Leave at least two general comments.
3. Assign an action item to yourself or one of your collaborators.

A few days later, Sherrie informs you that she is ready to share the spreadsheet with the On the Rise leadership team for review. She provides you the team emails and you invite each member, assigning them commenter permission only.

Leadership team members access the spreadsheet and leave numerous comments. They also assign action items for Sherrie West and Thomas Omar.

Complete the following steps:

1. Share the spreadsheet with the leadership team (choose another colleague, and let them know as before that you are undertaking a training exercise) with commenter permission. To share silently, you can uncheck the **Notify people** box when sharing.

Next, you play the role of someone on the leadership team.

2. Leave at least two general comments.
3. Assign an action item to yourself or one of your collaborators.

Task 8

The next day, Sherrie reviews the feedback she received. She notes that she needs to make a few updates to the spreadsheet and asks for your help responding to the leadership team.

Complete the following steps:

1. Select **Open comment history** in the top right to easily view comments.
2. Reply to one of the comments with a “thank you.”
3. Delete one of the comments.
4. Resolve a comment.
5. Mark an action item as done.
6. Link to a comment by @mentioning your colleague in your reply.

Case wrap-up

Sitting at her desk, Sherrie opens her laptop and reviews the final version of her spreadsheet “On the Rise employee openings - North America - East region”. She reflects on using Google Sheets and working collaboratively with her team. She was able to transform the numbers coming in from the stores across the North America - East region into practical insights. She and the On the Rise leadership can use these insights to help guide their recruitment efforts. Sherrie notes that this approach has been so successful it should be applied in other regions. The team can then proactively support the human resources needs of On the Rise.